

A Collective Review of Google Gemini's Policies

By Austen Stuart, Beckie Budds and Tristan Baraburiye

Beckie Budds Question 1

Q1: How was Google Gemini's training data collected?

A1: Gemini's terms of service does not explicitly say how the original training data was collected but it does outline how user input is collected and helps continue to train Gemini. Google uses the content that Gemini Apps generate, model thinking steps, information from connected apps, information from apps on the user's device, information about the apps, browsers and devices you use to access Gemini Apps, interactions between Gemini and the user's apps, browsers and devices, systems permissions and device data when you use Gemini mobile apps, remote browser data, context info from devices and services used with Gemini, information collected through supplemental Gemini Apps features, location information, and subscription information to further train Gemini.

Beckie Budds Question 1

Q2: Are there any limitations on Gemini's use?

A2: Google's Generative AI Prohibited Use Policy outlines guidelines that relate directly to how Gemini rejects policy breaking prompts, images, videos, and other content. As a chatbot, Gemini has automatic content filtering that may prompt the AI to show a warning message when restricted content/prompts are used or if a prompt redirects to unsafe content. There are four main policies that Google's Generative AI Prohibited Use Policy uses to restrict prohibited content. First: do not engage in dangerous or illegal activities, or otherwise violate applicable law or regulations. Second: Do not compromise the security of others' or Google's services. Third: Do not engage in sexually explicit, violent, hateful, or harmful activities. Fourth: Do not engage in misinformation, misrepresentation, or misleading activities.

Beckie Budds Question 3

Q3: Are there any warnings or safeguards in Gemini's interface?

A3: Google Support details how Gemini helps protect users from malicious content and prompt injection. If Gemini detects malicious activity such as prompt injection, the response may be blocked, Gemini may warn the user that the content they're requesting or using has security risks, content from the user may be refused if it is deemed malicious, and if only part of the information is deemed malicious that information will be filtered out by Gemini.

Do you believe the policy is sufficient for an ethical approach?

No, I do not believe the policy is sufficient for an ethical approach. While yes, the transparency is available for consumers if they look hard enough, it positioned cryptically in their help page and worded in such a way, that most consumers will skip the terms of service when opting in to using Gemini's services, and I think that both of these are an intentional design decision on Google's part.

What parts of the policy address ethical issues well?

Google gives users the ability of requesting a “removal of content” which is, in my opinion, great. This theoretically allows users to have their data be firmly back in their hands, by have the choice of how long it remains in Google’s database. Users can also object to the processing of personal data by submitting a request so that they make sure their private information isn’t being fed into the LLM directly.

The terms do however mention that the removal might take time and they are within their rights to use that data while it’s being removed. The time it takes is also vague, and dependent on the type of data.

What dangers can you see that are not addressed? Do you think it is intentional? Do the dangers impact some groups of people more than others?

The number of data points they collect on every user of the site is astronomical. They collect audio, video, transcripts of chat logs and so much more. This can be very dangerous if in the wrong hands, and while google hasn't done anything malicious with this data, should a data breach occur, the cyber attackers would have access to everything. While this is not an intentional danger from google, the danger is still present, and no amount of security can make the danger go away. This danger might also affect certain groups more than others, depending on what the cyber attackers might be targeting, such as certain racial groups or political figures.

Tristan's Notes

- What does the company say about their liability for issues caused by the model?

States that you can report a problem and if the response is unsatisfactory, then you can give feedback on whether it was good or bad following with a reason. There are more than a few guidelines reiterating the legal precautions with Gemini. This is especially present in the security and privacy detecting features of the software.

- Are there any principles of the UK Data and AI Ethics Framework which are not followed? If yes, is there a way to fix this within the existing model?

Although there is no clear environmental sustainability guideline that Gemini follows that would meet the standards of the UK Data and AI Ethics Framework, a way to remedy that would be to utilize the Keep Activity feature since that determines what data is saved or not.

LINK OF HYRULE

THE TRUE LINK:

https://support.google.com/gemini/answer/13594961?visit_id=639190298431646921-641392935&p=privacy_notice&rd=1#privacy_notice&zipy=%2Cwhat-terms-apply-to-use-of-gemini-apps